Yiran Sun

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EDUCATION

University of Leeds Leeds, United Kingdom
Bachelor of Arts (Hons) Sep 2024 - Jun 2027

- Programme: Digital Media
- Interim Result: 64 (Upper Second Class)
- Core Courses: Understanding Digital Media, Introduction to Media and Communication Theory, Video Games: Identities in Play, Design for Digital Media, Interface Design, Digital Storytelling, Programming for Digital Media, Promotional Culture, Digital Governance

INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

***New Media Content Intern*, Phoenix TV Shenzhen Management Centre** Shenzhen, China, Jun 2026 – Jul 2026
Tiger Talk Program Team | Internet Version Episode 1: AI on the Job: On What Grounds Do Humans Remain Employed

- Extracted high-potential clips from 60+ minutes of footage on AI replacing jobs; supported short-video strategy across Douyin and WeChat Channels, contributing to increased episode views.
- Edited and fact-checked WeChat public account articles by integrating guest backgrounds, debate logic and data verification, ensuring 100% consistency with the broadcast content.
- Transcribed and proofread ~12,000 words of dialogue across three cross-check rounds; corrected subtitles, timelines and wording to prevent post-production rework and ensure zero major errors.
- Coordinated with video editors and WeChat editors, provided time-coded highlights, verified questionable guest data, and proposed audience-oriented content angles partly adopted by the team.
- Balanced controversy and objectivity in clip selection by retaining context, avoiding misleading edits on AI and employment, and guiding rational public discussion.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

The Silenced Flock : Visibility Archive of Women's Health Content under Platform Algorithms
Course Assignment for ***Working in Digital Media Teams*** *- Scored at 72 |* ***Research Team Leader***

- Led the team and shaped the core concept of examining how platform algorithms, community guidelines and commercial moderation suppress women's health content, using the "silenced flock" metaphor to turn invisible censorship into a visible public archive for women aged 18–25.
- Coordinated mixed-method research, including questionnaire surveys, Xiaohongshu observations and cross-regional news cases; identified patterned deletion, shadowbanning and reach reduction—90%+ had seen suppressed content, 37.3% of posters experienced reduced reach, 93.2% believed it affected public access to health information.
- Produced a cross-media ecosystem containing a website, a magazine "The Silent Flock", a heat-sensitive service box "Unblockable Her", women's health daily products and a poster series; combined online evidence archive with offline campus/community/café interventions to bypass algorithmic and keyword filtering.
- Oversaw technical implementation and built a responsive front-end with HTML/CSS/JavaScript and a PHP/MySQL prototype for categorised cases, anonymous submissions and evidence archiving; managed task allocation, design–tech integration and project delivery.

Digital Media Portfolio: Critical Technical Practice & Data Activism
Course Assignment for ***Programming for Digital Media*** *- Scored at 72*

- Built a multi-project portfolio across creative coding, platform-based web building, no-code app development, PHP debugging and physical computing; produced a p5.js music visualiser, WordPress chocolate brand site with Astra/Elementor, Thunkable interactive app and Arduino "Love Thermometer" LED system.

- Designed a data-activism project using PHP and Chart.js to retrieve and visualise musicians' streaming royalty data, exposing creator-economy inequities and translating raw data into accessible public narratives.
- Conducted a theory-driven Python web-scraping study in Google Colab on Wikipedia's "Artificial Intelligence" entry, evaluating data-source feasibility and reflecting on access restrictions, sample bias, data authenticity and research ethics.
- Integrated critical media and platform theory (Armitage; van Dijck; Schrock; Landers et al.; Weiss) into each technical task, connecting digital production to platform power, digital labour, data justice and embodied technology.

Player Identity as Produced and Constrained by Game Systems

*Course Assignment for **Video Games: Identities in Play** - Scored at 71*

- Argued that player identity in 3A narrative games is not a free personal choice but a process continuously shaped and limited by power, interactivity and immersion, through a comparative study of Cyberpunk 2077 and The Last of Us.
- Built a critical framework combining Foucault's sovereign power/biopower, Bogost's procedural rhetoric, player-agency and avatar theories, and embodiment/immersion perspectives to analyse game design as an ideological mechanism.
- Conducted comparative textual analysis of linear narrative, fixed character relations, open-world choice, character customisation, mission branching and first-person embodiment, using cases such as The Last of Us hospital ending and Cyberpunk 2077's V/Johnny identity conflict.
- Concluded two contrasting identity models—"you must become who you are" vs. "you think you can decide who you are"—demonstrating that game mechanics are non-neutral cultural texts reflecting broader social power structures.

From Concept to Code: A Multi-Disciplinary Interface Design Portfolio

*Course Assignment for **Interface Design** - Scored at 68*

- Designed and built a professional digital portfolio website from scratch with HTML5/CSS3, presenting four projects: brand identity (Leeds Private Detective), social-issue illustration (global warming series), speculative design (VR home-working future scenario) and multi-format event promotion (Coconut Carving Festival).
- Structured the site with clear information architecture—homepage, systematic folder hierarchy and full navigation to each project page—while maintaining consistent visual identity and accessible, device-responsive layouts.
- Wrote W3C-compliant, clean code with precise control of spacing, alignment and colour; gained end-to-end experience from design output to web presentation, enabling independent implementation of digital content showcases.

Offline Diary: Mediated Perception and Memory (Video Format)

*Course Assignment for **Digital Storytelling** - Scored at 61*

- Explored how a broken phone disrupted device-mediated recording, shifting from photographing/capturing life to hand-drawing/perceiving it; framed a critical question on whether device-based recording weakens authentic experience and personal memory.
- Applied digital storytelling theory and techniques: used Scott McCloud's "amplification through simplification" to position hand-drawing as an alternative recording mode; structured the narrative as Breakdown–Awakening–Sharing via storyboard and handled live-action-to-animation transitions.
- Produced the video independently, combining live-action, hand-drawn animation, stop-motion and ambient sound, using slowed pacing and sound suppression/recovery to visualise the perceptual shift when screens are absent.

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

- **Languages**: Chinese (Native), English (Proficient, Degree Taught in English)
- **IT Skills**:

  Programming & Development: HTML5 / CSS3 / JavaScript, PHP / MySQL, Python, p5.js (Creative Coding), Chart.js (Data Visualisation), Arduino (Physical Computing), Thunkable (No-code App Development)

  Web&Platforms: WordPress (Astra Theme, Elementor Page Builder), Responsive Design & W3C Standards

  Creative & Media Production: Adobe Photoshop / Illustrator, Premiere Pro / CapCut, InDesign

  Office & Collaboration: WPS, Microsoft Word/Excel/PowerPoint